

Data Sources Explainer

epac only displays data that traces to official public sources. It is not a news app, a commentary app, or an AI-generated summary product.

Source map

Source	What it supports	Authority level	Classroom caveat
House of Commons Hansard	Debate text, Question Period, speeches	Official verbatim parliamentary record	Records what was said, not whether a claim was true.
Recorded divisions	MP votes and outcomes	Official voting record	A vote shows a decision, not every reason behind it.
LEGISinfo	Bill stages, text, sponsor, chamber status	Official legislative information system	Status does not measure public support.
Proactive disclosure	MP travel, hospitality, and contract expenses	Official quarterly disclosure	Expenses need role and geography context.
Elections Canada	Ridings and electoral history	Independent election administrator	Boundaries change after redistribution.
Statistics Canada	Census and riding context	National statistical agency	Census variables are not individual-level facts.
Commissioner of Lobbying registry	Lobbying registrations and communication reports	Official lobbying registry	A communication report shows contact, not agreement or influence.

How students should cite epac work

- Use epac to find the record, then cite the official source behind it.
- Use dates, institution names, and source URLs wherever possible.
- Screenshots help with review, but source URLs are stronger evidence.

What epac does not claim

epac does not rank MPs by ideology, score parties by preference, infer motive, summarize debates with generative AI, or decide whether a political statement is true.

Verification exercise

1. Pick a speech, vote, bill, or expense item.

2. Identify the institution that published it.
3. Locate the original record.
4. Write two sentences explaining what the record proves.
5. Write one sentence explaining what the record does not prove.